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LECTURE NOTES

# Discrete Mathematics notes

*Counting*

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DM549 - Discrete Mathematics

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# 1 Counting Rules

The following rules are nice to remember for counting.

## Definition: The Division Rule

Suppose  $A$  is a finite set with  $A = B_1 \cup B_2 \cup \dots \cup B_n$  where

- $|B_i| = d \quad \forall i$  and
- $B_i \cap B_j = \emptyset \quad \forall i, j \quad \text{where } i \neq j$

Then  $n = |A|/d$ .

## Definition: The Product Rule

For any finite sets  $S_1, S_2, \dots, S_n$

$$\underbrace{\left| \bigtimes_{i=1}^n S_i \right|}_{|S_1 \times S_2 \times \dots \times S_n|} = \underbrace{\prod_{i=1}^n |S_i|}_{{|S_1|} \cdot {|S_2|} \cdot \dots \cdot {|S_n|}}.$$

## Definition: The Sum Rule (for two sets)

For any finite sets  $S_1, S_2$  with  $S_1 \cap S_2 = \emptyset$ , it holds that  $|S_1 \cup S_2| = |S_1| + |S_2|$ .

## Definition: The Sum Rule

For any finite sets  $S_1, S_2$  with  $S_1 \cap S_2 = \emptyset$ , it holds that

$$\underbrace{\left| \bigcup_{i=1}^n S_i \right|}_{|S_1 \cup S_2 \cup \dots \cup S_n|} = \underbrace{\sum_{i=1}^n |S_i|}_{{|S_1|} + {|S_2|} + \dots + {|S_n|}}.$$

## Definition: The Subtraction Rule

For any finite sets  $S_1, S_2, \dots, S_n$  it holds that  $|S_1| \cup |S_2| = |S_1| + |S_2| - |S_1 \cap S_2|$ .

## 2 Pigeonhole

### The Pigeonhole Principle (Theorem 6.2.1 from book)

Let  $k \geq 1$  be an integer. When  $k + 1$  or more objects are placed into  $k$  boxes, there exists at least one box that contains at least two of the objects.

- Intuition: If there exists 10 holes, but 11 pigeons, at least one hole must contain 2 pigeons.

## 3 Permutations and combinations

Permutations count ordered selections of  $r$  elements from a set  $S$  of  $n$  elements (order matters).

### Permutations 1

If  $n > 0 \in \mathbb{Z}$  and  $r \in \mathbb{Z}$  such that  $1 \leq r \leq n$ , then there are

$$P(n, r) = n(n-1)(n-2)\dots(n-r+1)$$

$r$ -permutations of a set with  $n$  distinct elements.

### Permutations 2

If  $n, r \in \mathbb{Z}$  such that  $0 \leq r \leq n$ , then

$$P(n, r) = \frac{n!}{(n-r)!}$$

### Combinations

The number of  $r$ -combinations of a set with  $n$  elements, where  $n > 0 \in \mathbb{Z}$  and  $r \in \mathbb{Z}$  such that  $0 \leq r \leq n$ , equals

$$C(n, r) = \frac{n!}{r!(n-r)!}$$

Note that  $C(n, r)$  can also be written as  $\begin{bmatrix} n \\ r \end{bmatrix}$  ( $r$  choose  $r$ ), known as the binomial coefficient

🤔.

## 4 Binomial Coefficient

### The Binomial Theorem

Let  $x$  and  $y$  be variables, and let  $n > 0 \in \mathbb{Z}$

Then.

$$(x + y)^n = \sum_{j=0}^n \binom{n}{j} x^{n-j} y^j = \binom{n}{0} x^n + \binom{n}{1} x^{n-1} y + \dots + \binom{n}{n-1} x y^{n-1} + \binom{n}{n} y^n.$$

Where  $\binom{n}{j} = C(n, j) = \frac{n!}{j!(n-j)!}$

## 5 Repetition and indistinguishably

### Theorem: Repeating combinations

There are  $C(n + r - 1, r) = C(n + r - 1, n - 1)$   $r$ -combinations from a set with  $n$  elements when repetition is allowed

|                                | $k$ -distinguishable boxes                          | $k$ -indistinguishable boxes                                                     |
|--------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| $n$ -distinguishable objects   | $\frac{n!}{n_1! \cdot n_2! \cdot \dots \cdot n_k!}$ | $\sum_k^{j=1} \frac{1}{j!} \sum_{i=1}^{j-1} (-1)^{j-i} \binom{j-1}{i-1} (j-i)^n$ |
| $n$ -indistinguishable objects | $C(n + 1 - 1, k)$                                   | No formula                                                                       |

Table 1: Good to remember 😊

|                       | number of<br>$r$ -permutations of $S$ | number of<br>$r$ -combinations of $S$ |
|-----------------------|---------------------------------------|---------------------------------------|
| without<br>repetition | $P(n, r)$                             | $C(n, r)$                             |
| with<br>repetition    | $n^r$                                 | $C(n + r - 1, r)$                     |

Table 2: Good to remember 2 😊